

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9
 ♥ 10 8 6
 ♦ K J 9
 ♣ 8 7 6 3 2

♠ Q J 7 4

♥ A K

♦ 10 8 6 2

♣ A K Q



♠ 10 8 5 2
 ♥ Q J 9 4 3
 ♦ Q 4
 ♣ J 9

♠ A 6 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 7 5 3

♣ 10 5 4

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	2♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North

and then a small ♠ back toward your ♠ Q J. Here West puts the ♠ K on and you are home-free.

You were a little lucky that West's ♠ K fell on the second round.

If it had not dropped you would just have played a third round of ♠ s, hoping for a 3-3 split in the suit.

Clickagain.

You could also have gotten 3 ♠ winners with this distribution.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥ Q.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 7

You need two more winners and ♦ s is your longest combined suit. But you can only establish one extra winner in ♦ s, and before you could even do that the defenders would have taken a bunch of ♥ tricks.

So you must turn to the ♠ s for the extra two winners.

You win the first ♥ and lead . . . which ♠? If you play the ♠ Q you will go down, even if East has the ♠ K. He would cover and you would be held to just 2 ♠ tricks.

The only way to get 3 tricks from this holding is to play West for the ♠ K. So play a ♠ to dummy's ♠ A

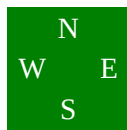
Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 7 5
 ♥ A J 3
 ♦ A 8 6
 ♣ 10 9 6 3

♠ K J 8 4
 ♥ 10 9 4 2
 ♦ Q J 10 5
 ♣ 5



♠ Q 3
 ♥ K Q 5
 ♦ K 9 4 2
 ♣ Q J 7 4

♠ 10 9 6 2
 ♥ 8 7 6
 ♦ 7 3
 ♣ A K 8 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♣A, then ♣K, ♣2. North follows once, then discards a ♠ and a ♥.

South leads the ♣A, then ♣K, ♣2. North follows once, then discards a ♠ and a ♥.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=3 ♦=2 ♣=2 Total = 8

There are two possibilities for getting an extra winner. If the ♦s are splitting 3-3 you could play ♦A, ♦K and another ♦ and establish the thirteenth ♦ as a winner. Or you could play North for the ♠K and lead toward your ♠Q.

The chance of North holding the ♠K is a little greater than 50%. (it is higher than the usual 50% because we know he started with only one ♣, giving him more spaces for other cards).

The chance of ♦s splitting 3-3 is about 40%.

So you should enter dummy with a ♥ and play a small ♠ toward your ♠Q.

Did it work?

You might have thought of another possibility; duck a ♦, then play ♦A and ♦K to see if the ♦s split before you try leading toward the ♠Q.

The problem is that you might run into this very distribution. You would establish a ♦ for North and when you played a ♠ from dummy North would jump up with the ♠K and cash his winning ♦ for down 1.

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 3
 ♥ Q 7 3
 ♦ K Q J 9 5
 ♣ 8 4

♠ 9 4 2

♥ A 8 5

♦ 7 6 3

♣ A K 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 8 7 6

♥ 10 6 4 2

♦ 8 2

♣ 10 7 3

♠ A Q 5

♥ K J 9

♦ A 10 4

♣ Q J 9 2

West	North	East	South
1♦	Pass	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South
 ♣s ending in your hand.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♦K.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=4 Total = 8

You only need one more winner. If East has the ♠K or the ♥Q a simple finesse will give you the trick.

There are two problems though. The first one is that if West gets in he may take too many ♦ tricks. But the bigger problem is that East cannot possibly have either of those two high cards. You and dummy together hold 28 HCP and West must surely hold the other 12 since he opened the bidding. Neither simple finesse will work so you must try what is called a Backward Finesse.

Hold up the ♦A until the third round to confirm that East has only 2. He does. Then play four rounds of

Now play the ♥J. If West doesn't cover, you will let it ride for your ninth trick. But West does cover so you must take dummy's ♥A. Next play a small ♥ from dummy and finesse the ♥9, hoping East has the ♥10. This is the Backward Finesse.

The Backward Finesse is a pretty rare play. It is against the odds so you only try it when you are absolutely certain that a normal finesse is doomed to fail.

Like this time.

By the way. Those of you with great short-term memories might think they have seen this hand before. Well, you ALMOST have. Deal 8 has an almost identical layout but a much simpler theme. Check it out.